A Super Rare Baseball Card Is Up for Auction

From: Popular Science Mined: 2026-10-14 3 min read

One of the most famous baseball cards ever is for sale at an **auction**. People have already **bid** more than $1 million for it!

The card shows a player named Honus Wagner. It was made between 1909 and 1911. Heritage **Auctions** calls it the Holy Grail of baseball cards, which means it is something **collectors** want very badly.

Honus Wagner played **shortstop** for the Pittsburgh Pirates from 1900 to 1917. He won eight batting titles. In 1937, he was one of the first players picked for the Baseball **Hall of Fame**.

Why is the card so rare? Long ago, cards came with tobacco products. A **legend** says Wagner asked the company to stop making his card because it was used to sell cigarettes. So very few were made.

Bidding ends on October 25. The sellers think the card will sell for at least $3 million. Earlier this year, a similar Wagner card sold for more than $5.8 million.

Word Treasure

auction -- A sale where people offer more and more money, and the highest offer wins.
bid -- Offered an amount of money to buy something.
collectors -- People who gather and save special things, like cards.
shortstop -- A baseball player who stands between second and third base.
Hall of Fame -- A place that honors the very best players in a sport.
legend -- An old story that many people tell, which may or may not be fully true.

Background you need

Baseball cards show pictures of players, and people have collected them for more than 100 years.

A card is worth more money when it is very rare and shows a famous player.

At an auction, people keep offering more money until time runs out, and the highest offer wins.

Break it down

WHO: Heritage Auctions and baseball star Honus Wagner
WHAT: A super rare Wagner baseball card is for sale at an auction
WHERE: Heritage Auctions, with bidding until October 25
WHY: Very few of his cards were made, so collectors want them badly

Why it matters

It shows that a small card from a hobby many kids enjoy can become a valuable piece of history.

Test what you remember

1. Who is shown on the rare baseball card?

- (A) Honus Wagner
- (B) A team mascot
- (C) A coach
- (D) A football player

2. How much have people already bid?

- (A) Nothing yet
- (B) $10
- (C) More than $1 million
- (D) About $500

3. Which team did Honus Wagner play for?

- (A) The Pittsburgh Pirates
- (B) The Los Angeles Dodgers
- (C) The Chicago White Sox
- (D) The New York Mets

4. Why are so few of his cards around, according to a legend?

- (A) He asked the company to stop making them because they sold cigarettes
- (B) Kids ate them
- (C) They were too big
- (D) They were lost at sea

5. When does bidding end?

- (A) Next week
- (B) October 25
- (C) New Year's Day
- (D) July 4

6. What did a similar Wagner card sell for earlier this year?

- (A) $3
- (B) More than $5.8 million
- (C) $1,000
- (D) $100

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: A 4: A 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):